

console versions do not support games of older consoles). After many requests by customers, there is word in the air that PS5 may extend support for some PS4 titles, but only the digitally-downloaded ones. While this fact is yet to be verified, as of now, computers are a better bet than consoles in this consideration. These can run a game released anytime in the ages. Some very old or legacy games may face issues with the latest operating systems, but there is always a work-around.

Even more interestingly, online platforms like Steam, Origin, Windows Store and GOG bring all the endless libraries of games to PC users, with frequent sales and discounts. On the other hand, games for consoles, be it digital or on a disk, are costlier, with seldom any discounts being offered.

Technical know-how

Consoles are the easiest to use, fix and get support for. These are basically plug-and-play devices, and many of the troubles that come their way can be resolved simply by a reload or, at the most, a factory reboot. If the problem persists, assistance from vendors is readily available. Even game producers are also well-accessible.

Computer users, on the other hand, have minimum technical knowledge to troubleshoot and resolve issues, be it with games or systems. Help with system hardware can still be found. But if there is a glitch in the game file or in the installation, that can be solved mostly by the users themselves. Help can be found mostly from online communities and other sources available on the Internet.



A gaming desktop setup (Credit: flickr.com)



Destiny 2 is awesome to play in full graphics on a console (Credit: flickr.com)

Space and portability

Laptops were made specifically for these reasons! These are wireless mobile devices and occupy the least amount of space. The portability factor comes with a trade-off with peak performance capacity. Yet, this is the only option out of the three systems that lets you game on-the-go.

A gaming console is a single box that connects to your TV. The only other peripheral required is the controller (unless you are using a VR or Kinect set). These too fit into one corner of your room without occupying much space. Consoles are becoming slimmer over the days as well.

Desktops require a lot of space owing to peripherals such as CPU, screen, speaker system, keyboard, mouse, UPS and so on. These often require a computer-table for an effective setup and, hence, take the maximum amount of space among the three.

Other functions

Desktop and laptop computers can carry out every other system-related function, including streaming any kind of media files, browsing the Internet, configuring other devices, making presentations, and office work or operations like programming and coding.

Game consoles offer a limited range of functions, mostly pertaining to entertainment such as watching a movie, playing stored audio, video or image files, streaming videos online through

Netflix, YouTube and Plex, among others, and surf the Internet. Other operations are not supported by consoles.

Summarising

When I moved to New Delhi in 2015, I planned to invest a little in my gaming hobby. Falling in between the casual-

and moderate-gamer's category, I had a tough time making my choice. Since I did not have enough space to invest in a complete desktop, and laptops within my budget did not meet the specs required, I decided to invest in a 500GB Sony PS3 Slim model for ₹21,000 (PS3 support is no longer available; PS4 is the current-generation device) and got myself a 76cm (30-inch) LCD TV, which cost me ₹15,000. For additional controllers and a few more accessories I had shell out another ₹6000. The whole setup's cost was much less than what an equivalent desktop or laptop would have cost me, given my requirements.

Moral of the story, all of this comes down to your priorities and budget. If you are a professional gamer with a knack for customisations, you can go for a gaming desktop and get the full experience. These are best-suited for gamers who have technical experience with hardware and software. You will also be able to carry out your daily computing activities with the computer.

Alternatively, for someone aiming to multitask and desiring mobility, laptop is the device.

Gaming consoles are budget-friendly for all kinds of users including novices, casual- and medium-level gamers and those who prefer a device fully dedicated to gaming. Even game-geeks can get great fun out of gaming consoles and explore the different kinds of operation the console software offers.

Now that you know the appropriate purpose of each system, which one do you deem worthy to replace your old laptop? Do let us know! **EFY**